The Complete History of America (Abridged)

By Adam Long, Reed Martin and Austin Tichenor

Suggested Roles:
Actor 1: *Reed, Austin, Sophia, Pastor, Franklin, Soldier, FDR, Hitler, Eva Braun, Hawkeye Pierce, Announcer 2, Contestant, Spade*
Actor 2: *Adam, Vespucci, Announcer, Minute Man, Madison, Sarge, Rock Fury, Game Show Host, Conspirator Guy*

NOTE: This cutting asks each student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

Notes from the Authors: *Although we use the names Adam, Reed, and Austin within the script, each cast member should use his own real name when performing the show.*

There are topical references in the script. The humor and relevance of these will fade over time, so we encourage each production to change these references to keep them as up-to-date as possible. [References have been updated for performances in 2026; changes appear in red]

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REED: **(Pg 3-4)** Good morning/afternoon/evening! I'm [insert name] and tonight we explore the history of a great nation.

ADAM: [After all] it is only through remembering our past that we can learn from our mistakes, or at least blame them on somebody else, and then move on . . . into a better future.

AUSTIN: **(Pg 5)** **[**Today] many Americans are at best uninformed or at worst embarrassed about our own history.

REED: Well, damn it, we've got nothing to be embarrassed about! We brought the world its first democracy . . . a man on the moon . . . McDonalds, Big Bird and Bart Simpson!

ADAM: Let's do it!

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR 1: *The Complete History of America (abridged)*
ACTOR 2: *by Adam Long, Reed Martin and Austin Tichenor*

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REED: **(Pg 5)** We begin at the beginning: 1492 Spain! The first chapter of the history of America is about to be written by that legendary Italian explorer . . . *(fanfare)* Amerigo Vespuchi! We join him now in his humble map shop.

VESPUCCI: *(bad Italian accent and flamboyant hand-gestures)* Ring-a! Ring-a! *(Answering his hand)* Hello, Maps-R-Us. Amerigo Vespucci here . . .

SOPHIA: Amerigo!

VESPUCCI: **(Pg 6)** Shaddup, woman! I'm on the telephone!

SOPHIA: My parents told me not to marry you. They said, "Marry a nice boy, like that Christopher Columbus. He's going places!

VESPUCCI: *(Looks into phone)* Hello? *(He hangs up)* Great! You just lost me a customer. I hope you're happy, Sophia!

SOPHIA: **(Pg 7)** Let's face it, Amerigo, nobody buys your maps because they're crap!

VESPUCCI: I can't stay here any longer. I'm off to discover a larger world. You will never see me again!

SOPHIA: Amerigo!!!!!

REED: **(Pg 8)** In 1502, after two long, treacherous voyages, Amerigo concluded that what everyone had thought was India was actually a new world. Eventually it bore his name AMERICA!

ADAM: **(Pg 10)** Hey! [What about] Christopher Columbua? He discovered the New World!

REED: Well, his name really wasn't Christopher Columbus, it was Christobal Colon. And he bumped into the New World by mistake. He wasn't even the first one here! There was a native population of over 90 million people here before he arrived.

AUSTIN: Yeah, but in fairness to Columbus, though, he was the first man to slaughter and enslave the native population AND he became very wealthy in the process. So in that sense, he was the first true American!

ADAM: **(Pg 13)** Hey, can I do that poem I wrote? I wrote a poem about the first English settlement in North America

REED: **[FLASH FORWARD TO 1607]** *(Shrugs . . .)*

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ADAM: **(Pg 14-15)** 'Twas 1607, in the fine month of May,
That three proud ships land at Chesapeake Bay

Jamestown was born, so the story was told,
To spread our Lord's word and for mining of gold.

The livin' was harsh for those brave men and women.
They toiled and they sweated and rarely went swimmin'.

The new world was tamed by men who were brave
And men who were strong and six million slaves
(shocked expressions and the raps peters out)
And indentured servants and the Iroquois nation
Who gave up their land without compensation

(Trying to regain momentum) So the Pilgrims perfected the art of good livin',
They carved up the land and invented Thanksgivin'
And lickety split, just as quick as you please,
Wham barn ma'am there were thirteen colonies

PASTOR: Hello, and welcome to our weekly meeting of Salem's First Church of Tolerance and National Witchhunter's Association. I am your pastor, the Reverend Orwell. Last night the Lord came to me and He said . . . You and your followers need to kill 100 witches this week or I'm going to call you home! So I urge you to hunt the good hunt. And don't forget that this witch-hunt will begin an American tradition that will carry on well into the twentieth century! Here's how you spot a real witch: They melt when you throw water on them, they're surrounded by flying monkeys and they **may actually run for president someday!**

AUSTIN: **(Pg 16)** Hey! The king has doubled our taxes and we're putting together a people's army to fight him right now. We're off to throw tea in the harbor!

ANNOUNCER: **(Pg 17)** Paul Revere and the Raiders number on the charts with "The British are Coming"

ADAM: Listen, my children, and you shall hear of the midnight ride of Paul Revere!

AUSTIN: **(Pg 18)** And a full-fledged revolution was underway. The colonists wanted to stop the British government from imposing unfair taxes, so that the American government could

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impose unfair and exorbitant taxes. George Washington commanded a tiny contingent of fighters known as the Minute Men – fighting for American liberty.

MINUTE MAN: **(Pg 20)** *(reading from flyer)* Expel the Evil Empire from North America and meet chick. High frostbite tolerance a plus. No tea drinkers, please. Be all that you can be. Apply in person – Valley Forge

REED: **(Pg 18)** *(singing)* We represent the Lexington League

The Lexington League

The Lexington League

And in the name of the Lexington League . . .

We wish to welcome you to Valley Forge!

ADAM: **(Pg 22)** So the rebel troops brought the Brits to their knees! And finally in Yorktown in Fall '81, the British surrendered – The Yankees had won!

REED: imme an M! Gimme an E! Gimme an R! I! C! Gimme an A! Whtzzat spell? 'MURRICA!

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MADISON: **(Pg 23)** I can't believe the Bill of Rights is due tomorrow.

FRANKLIN: Now, as the world's first democracy, I think we should guarantee Freedom of Religion, Freedom of the Press, and Freedom of Speech.

MADISON: If you guarantee all those rights, people are going to be saying all kinds of crazy stuff and pissing each other off.

FRANKLIN: Well, then, let's give everyone the right to carry a gun to shot each other, and the right to a fair and speedy trial by a jury of their peers after they do. Are we in agreement?

MADISON: Totally! . . . . [Until . . . . }

REED: **(Pg 31)** The Civil War!

ANNOUNCER: **(Pg 33)** The war was the bloodiest in the history of the nation. At the heart of the fighting was the issue of slavery. And when abolitionist Abraham Lincoln *(cough "Republican")* became President in 1861, the South seceded from the Union. **(Pg 34)** But in the end, the South surrendered, and they all lived happily ever after. Except for Abraham Lincoln who was shot in the head by John Wilkes Booth.

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(Pg 37-38) *(Marching in place while saluting, hum a few bars of "Over There" *****)*

SOLDIER: World War I – The Trenches *(jumps into a trench somewhere in France. Mime a gun and peak out grimly over the edge of the trench)* You think they're still out there, Sarge? It's pretty quiet out there.

SARGE: Yeah. Too quiet . . . They're out there. Every last one of them! *(he peers through binoculars)* My God!

SOLDIER: We're outnumbered a hundred to one! **(Pg 39)** *(Panicking)* I gotta get outa here! I'm too young to die!

SARGE: Calm down, soldier! *(Slaps him)* **(Pg 37)** We're expendable. We got a job to do and we do it. Case closed!

SOLDIER: But don't you see?! We're trapped! We're just cannon fodder for the military-industrial complex!

SARGE: (Pg 40) All right, we're going over the top! Let's go!!! *(He leaps out of the foxhole and is instantly struck down)*

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ANNOUNCER: (Pg 41) Dateline 1919. The Treaty of Versailles is signed. The Great War is over. 18th Amendment ratified, creating Prohibition. And the Golden Ae of Radio unites the country from sea to shining sea! Until . . . .[World War II] **(Pg 46)** Suddenly, over the hills in a cloud of dust and the sound of a thundering wheelchair, appears Franklin Delano Roosevelt!

FDR: My fellow Americans, the only thing we have to fear is fear itself. We hereby declare war on the Axis powers!

ANNOUNCER: . . . and now back to the exciting conclusion of Rock Fury, Super GI!

HITLER: Look! Ze alies are marcing into Berlin. Zey are falling right into my trap. Now I wll press zis button, firing the secret Uberveapon zat vill vipe out ze whole Allied force. Ha-ha-ha-ha! *(Woosh sound, the sound of a man flying)* **(Pg 47)** Ach, Vut is zat noise? Oh, no! It's a bird, it's a plane . . .

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ROCK FURY: No! It's Rock Fury, Super GI! Your jib-dancing days are over, little man! In its greed and lust for power, Germany has tried to take over an entire continent.

HITLER: But isn't zat vut ze US did in Norze America?

ROCK FURY: We didn't try to wipe out an entire race of people!

EVA BRAUN: Vut about ze Indians?

ROCK FURY: Well, we don't lock people away in concentration camps.

EVA BRAUN: Vut about ze Japanese-Americans on the Vest Coast?

ROCK FURY: *(Unable to answer, he addresses the audience)* **(Pg 48)** Well, thank goodness we won this war; otherwise, the German and Japanese economies would dominate the world!

HAWKEYE PIERCE: Help, Help!

ROCK FURY: Wait! My super hearing is picking up Alan Alda calling for help in Korea. Rock Fury, Super GI is off once again to battle for truth, justice and American markets! *(Whoosh sound as he flies away, followed by a news ticker sound)*

ANNOUNCER 2: This just in. Atom bombs dropped on Hiroshima and Nagasaki. Over two hundred thousand dead. That report in just a moment, but first it's time to play Queen for a Day! – The Game show which celebrates the achievements of American women! *(cheering and game show music)*

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GAME SHOW HOST: **(Pg 50)** Name the brave seamstress from Montgomery, Alabama, who refused to move to the back of the bus and jump-started the American civil rights movement?

CONTESTANT: **(Pg 51)** Whoopi Goldberg? *(buzzer sounds)*

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ADAM: **(Pg 54-55)** Okay . . . Postwar America – Film Noir Ending! *(dons an overcoat and fedora and steps out of the scene, noir style)*

SPADE: The name's Diamond, Spade Diamond. I'm a private eye! *(steps back into scene)*

CONSPIRATOR GUY: **(Pg 55)** If you know what's good for you, you'll drop this case before you start it. Unless you want to find out the truth!

SPADE: **(Pg 60)** Who are you!?

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CONSPIRATOR GUY: **(Pg 55)** Just call me the Conspirator Guy. **(Pg 68)** You want to know who caused the Cold War? Who benefited? *(Whispering)* The Generals!

SPADE: The military?

CONSPIRATOR GUY: No! No! General Motors, General Electric. They caused the Cold War! And . . . And . . . I shot JFK, not Lee Harvey Oswald! **(Pg 69)** I shot Bobby Kennedy, too. And Martin Luther King. And Malcolm X!

SPADE: Wow.

CONSPIRATOR GUY: And I shot Jr, and invented the AIDS virus and I whacked Nancy Kerrigan on the knee . . . It'd whack her again if I had half a chance . . . and I shrank the bloody glove so it wouldn't fit OJ anymore, and I told President Clinton "Go ahead! She's an intern! Who cares?" *(Spade shoots Conspirator Guy with his finger gun)*

SPADE: *(Steps our of the scene)* I had to put him out of my misery. So there it was. The Cold War was over and Communism was dead . . . well, except for a billion people in China.

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REED: **(Pg 70)** Thank you. Thank you. That was the Complete History of America! Is there anything we need to add here historically?

ADAM: Well, we left out a few people. **Kristi Noem, Pam Bondi, Pete Hegseth, Donald Trump, Jeffrey Epstein?**

AUSTIN: *(Considers for a moment)* Not that important.

ADAM: **COVID-19? Constitutional rights? Immigration Enforcement by ICE?**

AUSTIN: **To mask or not to mask . . . that is the question!**

ADAM: **(PG 71)** I'm [insert name]

AUSTIN: And I'm [Insert name] and that's history!

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

2004National Qualifier
2005 National Qualifier
2006 National Qualifier
2006 National Qualifier
2007 National Qualifier
2008 National Qualifier
2012 National Qualifier
2015 National Qualifier
2016 National Qualifier
2016 National Qualifier - MS
2019 National Qualifier
2020 National Qualifier
2024 National Qualifeir – MS
2025 National Qualifier
2025 National Qualifier – MS
NIETOC
FL State Qualifier
IL State Qualifier
KS State Qualifier
OH State Qualifier
UT State Qualifier

*** Music and Lyrics for "Over There"**
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Fz6Lv9djrZE

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